

Canvio Slim announced

Toshiba has announced a 500 GB Canvio Slim Portable Hard Drive, their slimmest portable drives yet, measuring just 9 mm in thickness



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External HDD Test

HOW WE TESTED

We divided the external drives into three categories in all. For Portable Drives we had a) Drives less than 1 TB and b) Drives greater than or equal to 1 TB. Drives that required an external power supply were clubbed together and there was no demarcation here based on the capacity as we got only 5 drives in total. Finally Flash drives were divided into a) Drives with capacity under 32, b) Drives with 32 GB capacity and c) Drives with a capacity over 32 GB.

The test bed had following components:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i7-3770K @ 3.5GHz
- **Memory:** 2 x 4GB Kingston HyperX DDR3 RAM @ 1333MHz and timing of 9-9-9-24
- **Motherboard:** ASRock Z77 Extreme 4
- **OS:** Windows 7 Ultimate (64-bit)
- **OS Drive:** Kingston Hyper X SH100S3 120GB SSD

- **Transfer Drive:** Kingston Hyper X SH100S3 120GB SSD
- **Graphics Card:** AMD Radeon HD 6850
- **Power Supply:** Corsair HX620W
- **Monitor:** BenQ EW2430

We installed a clean copy of Windows 7 Ultimate on the Kingston HyperX SH100S3 SSD and installed the synthetic benchmarks such as Crystal DiskMark 3.0.1 and SiSoftware Sandra 2012 on the SSD. Two partitions were created on the other Kingston SH100S3 SSD and we used it for real life data transfer tests.

We performed the SiSoft 2012 test on unformatted drives which gave us average read / write speeds and data access times. The Crystal DiskMark test was done with zero-fill data as well as with random data. Sequential and Random data read / write was recorded.

After this we divided the drives under test into equal capacity partitions. No partitions were created on the Flash Drives and they were only subjected to real world testing.

For our Real World tests we used a 4 GB RAR File and a 4 GB Assorted file, to simulate a sequential and assorted file transfer scenario. These files were copied to and from the Kingston SH100S3 (non-OS SSD) to the external drives under test. We also performed file transfer tests within the two partitions of the external drives. Finally, we used Adobe Photoshop CS2 to test the amount of time taken to load a 1GB file. Both the image and the scratch disk were kept on the test drives on the same partition, effectively stimulating file access. The cost per GB was included in calculating the Best Buy and we looked at the market prices of the drives.

hours while streaming movies, before it needed recharging.

Performance

Thanks to the 7200RPM drive housed within the Hitachi Mobile Touro, it was able to successfully cross the 115 MB/s mark in sequential read and write tests. It was also blazing fast when used as a scratch disk. Buffalo MiniStation Thunder-

bolt was the only other drive to achieve that. Silicon Power Stream S20 gave the third best performance scores. Most of the other drives in this category gave scores which were closer. Only Toshiba Canvio drive gave comparatively lower scores.

1 TB and over drives

This category was flooded with ten 1 TB drives with a single 1.5 TB and 2 TB being the only other drives. Clearly 1 TB is just about the right capacity if you are looking for a long-term portable drive.

Freecom had three drives in this segment of 1 TB each. We were particularly impressed with the aesthetics of each drive. The Freecom ToughDrive 3.0 as the name implies, is housed in a rubber casing and is water resistant with the USB 3.0 cable built into the casing. We really hated the short USB 3.0 cable though. Desktop users can forget using this drive unless you have a USB 3.0 cable extender. We loved the design on the Mobile Drive Sq, which



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